

Introduction to Human Sciences (HS8.102)
Spring 2026

Quiz Two
((Political Science Module)
Date- March 30, 2026

SECTION A

Max Time: 45 minutes

Max Marks: 40

Question 1 (600 words)

Marks: 30

Explain the different ways in which politics has been defined. Discuss at least three major conceptions with examples.

Introduction (concept of contested nature): 4 **marks**

Politics as art of government/ Politics as public affairs/ Politics as compromise and consensus/

Politics as power : 8 **marks** x 3 = 24 **marks**

Conclusion (comparison and synthesis): 2 **marks**

Question 2 (200 words)

Marks: 10

Write short notes on any one of the following

(1) Features of the Indian Constitution (5 x 2 Marks- key points plus 1-2 sentence explanation)

(2) Fundamental Rights in the Indian Constitution (5 x2 Marks- key points plus 1-2 sentence explanation)

What is Politics?

Defining Politics

- Politics as art of Government
- Politics as Public Affairs
- Politics as compromise and consensus
- Politics as Power

Politics is too serious a matter to be left to the politicians.

Charles de Gaulle

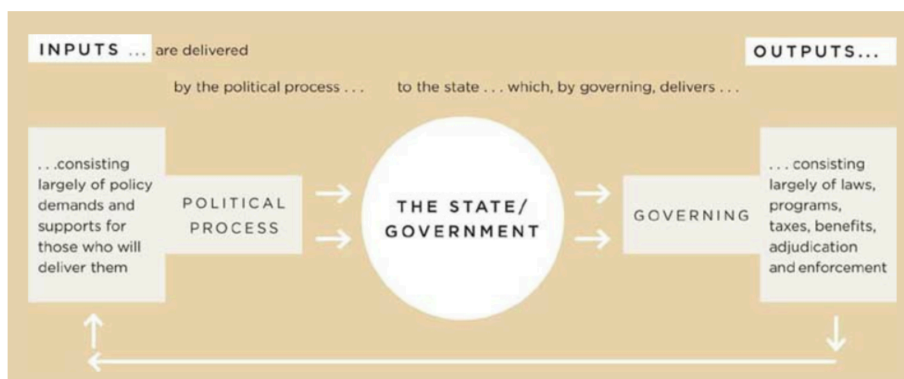
What is Politics?

Defining Politics: Politics as art of government

- **Bismark-** Politics is not a science, its an art. It is the art of government, the exercise of control within society through the making and enforcement of collective decisions.
- **Davis Easton-** Politics can be defined as the 'authoritative allocation of values.' Politics encompasses the various processes through which government responds to pressures from the larger society, in particular by allocating benefits, rewards or penalties.
- **Lord Acton-** "Power tends to corrupt, and absolute power corrupts absolutely"

What is Politics?

Defining Politics: Politics as Art of Government



David Easton's 'authoritative allocation of values'

What is Politics?

Defining Politics: Politics as Public Affairs

- As per this definition, distinction between ‘the political’ and ‘the non-political’ coincides with the division between public and private sphere of life.
- Traditionally, the distinction between the public realm and the private realm was thought to conform to the division between the state and civil society.
- Alternately, it is conceived as the **distinction between ‘the political’ and ‘the personal’**. This notion regards institutions such as businesses, community groups, clubs and trade unions as ‘public’.

What is Politics?

Defining Politics: Politics as Public Affairs

Public	Private
The state: apparatus of government	Civil society: autonomous bodies – businesses, trade unions, clubs, families, and so on
Public	Private
Public realm: politics, commerce, work, art, culture and so on	Personal realm: family and domestic life

What is Politics?

Defining Politics: Politics as Compromise and Consensus

- This conception of politics relates not to the arena within which politics is conducted but to the way in which decisions are made.
- Specifically, politics is seen as a particular means of resolving conflict: that is, by **compromise, conciliation and negotiation**, rather than through force and naked power.
- Stoker (2006)- ‘Politics is designed to disappoint’; its outcomes are ‘often messy, ambiguous and never final’.

What is Politics?

Defining Politics: Politics as Power

Three faces of power

Decision-making	Agenda setting	Thought control
• Ability to influence the content of decisions • Dahl's Who Governs? Democracy and Power in an American City (1961) - assessment of who holds power based on the decision-making abilities of the actors involved. • Keith Boulding: difference between force (the stick), productive exchanges (the deal), and the creation of loyalty (the kiss)	• Bachrach and Baratz (1962): ability to prevent decisions being made: that is, in effect, 'non-decision-making' • Involves the ability to set or control the political agenda, thereby preventing issues or proposals from being aired in the first place • Eg: Lobbying	• Ability to influence another by shaping what he or she thinks, wants, or needs • Ideological indoctrination or psychological control • Eg: Advertisements, propaganda

Features of Indian Constitution

Written Constitution	Fundamental Rights
Drawn from Various Sources	Fundamental Duties
Blend of Rigidity and Flexibility	Directive Principles of State Policy
Parliamentary Form of Democracy	Secularism with Indian Characteristics
Integrated and Independent Judiciary	Single Citizenship
Rule of Law	Universal Adult Franchise
Federal System with Unitary Bias	Autonomous Constitutional Bodies
Division of Power	Three-tier Government
Balance of Power	Co-operative Societies

Fundamental Rights

Article 14- Equality before Law

Article 15- Right against Discrimination

Article 16- Equality of Opportunity

Article 17- Abolition of Untouchability

Article 18- Abolition of Titles

Article 19- All citizens shall have the right—

- (a) to freedom of speech and expression;
- (b) to assemble peaceably and without arms;
- (c) to form associations or unions;
- (d) to move freely throughout the territory of India;
- (e) to reside and settle in any part of the territory of India;
- (g) to practise any profession, or to carry on any occupation, trade or business.

Fundamental Rights

Article 20- Protection with respect to conviction for offences

Article 21- Protection of Life and Personal Liberty

Article 22- Protection against Arrest and Detention

Article 23- Protection of Human Trafficking and Forced Labour

Article 24- Prohibition of Child Labour

Article 25- Freedom of Conscience, Profession, Practice and Propagation

Article 26- Freedom to Manage Religious Affairs

Article 27- Freedom from Taxation for Promotion of a Religion

Article 28- Freedom from Attending Religious Instruction

Article 29- Protection of Interests of Minorities

Article 30- Right of Minorities to Establish and Administer Educational Institutions

Article 32- Right to Constitutional Remedies